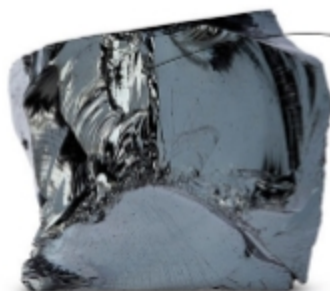


Selenium

34
Se

This non-metal has two pure forms—one is powdery and red, and the other is a hard, gray metal. Selenium is used to modify glass and to coat solar cells. Its compounds are found in many everyday products, from dandruff shampoos to photocopiers.



Metallic sheen on gray selenium

Red color due to a selenium glaze

Chunk of pure gray selenium refined in a laboratory

A touch of color

Certain selenium compounds can change the color of glass, such as providing an orange-red tint. Bright ruby reds or pink hues in glass are often due to the addition of selenium.

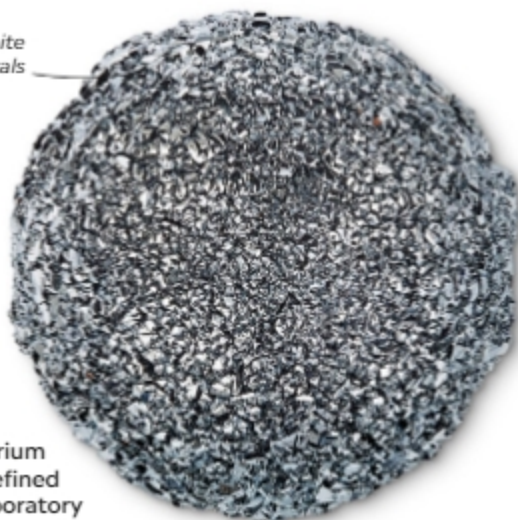


Tellurium

52
Te

Rare in Earth's crust, tellurium is named after *tellus*, the Latin name for "Earth." It's a toxic, silvery-white metalloid that is used in industry to make glass optical fibers and electronics.

Silvery-white crystals



Pure tellurium crystals refined in a laboratory

Sulfur

16
S

Once believed to be an important ingredient in the making of the Philosopher's Stone—a legendary substance capable of turning common metals into gold—sulfur was used widely by early alchemists. In its raw form, this non-metal is found as yellow crystals.

Pure sulfur has no smell, but its compounds often have egg-like smells. Sulfur is important for life—needed for healthy hair, skin, and muscles—and has lots of industrial uses, such as production of sulfuric acid.



Laboratory sample of pure sulfur granules



Celestine

Sometimes found in its pure native form, sulfur also appears in many compounds. The sulfur compound strontium sulfate is present in celestine, a pale blue crystalline mineral.

Sulfur springs

Volcanic hot springs are often a natural source of sulfur. The hot water in the springs is produced as a result of volcanic activity underground, and, as the water reaches the surface, it brings dissolved sulfur minerals with it. At this hot spring near the Dallol Volcano in Ethiopia, water containing sulfur has dried up, leaving behind a yellow crust.

